Generated from the award tables

Compare Players

Pick two players to compare their Men's Ballon d'Or and FIFA World Cup/UEFA EURO Golden Boot record - how many times each has won each award, generated straight from the same award tables as the "Players" directory. National teams are not included here; see "Compare" for that comparison.

Head-to-head

Lionel Messi	Award	Cristiano Ronaldo
BALLON D'OR		
8 ▲	Times won	5
2009, 2010, 2011, 2012, 2015, 2019, 2021, 2023	Years	2008, 2013, 2014, 2016, 2017
FIFA WORLD CUP GOLDEN BOOT		
Neither player has won this award.		
UEFA EURO GOLDEN BOOT		
0	Times won	2 ▲
—	Years	2012, 2020

Lionel Messi	Award	Cristiano Ronaldo
COMBINED		
8 ▲	Total awards	**7**

"Years" lists every year that player won the award in that row, oldest first. National-team competitions (World Cup, EURO, Copa América, Nations League titles) aren't included here: they recognize teams, not individual players - see Compare for that comparison.

Shared years

Every year Lionel Messi and Cristiano Ronaldo both won an award, whether or not it was the same one.

2012 **Lionel Messi**: Ballon d'Or **Cristiano Ronaldo**: UEFA EURO Golden Boot

All players

Every Ballon d'Or or Golden Boot winner, ranked by total awards. Pick any two above to compare them directly, or select a name below for their full year-by-year record on the Players page.

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
1	**Lionel Messi**	8	0	0	8
2	**Cristiano Ronaldo**	5	0	2	7
3	**Marco van Basten**	3	0	1	4
4	**Michel Platini**	3	0	1	4

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
5	**Gerd Müller**	1	1	1	3
6	**Harry Kane**	1	1	1	3
7	**Johan Cruyff**	3	0	0	3
8	**Ronaldo**	2	1	0	3
9	**Alfredo Di Stéfano**	2	0	0	2
10	**Dražan Jerković**	0	1	1	2
11	**Eusébio**	1	1	0	2
12	**Flórián Albert**	1	1	0	2
13	**Franz Beckenbauer**	2	0	0	2
14	**Hristo Stoichkov**	1	1	0	2
15	**Karl-Heinz Rummenigge**	2	0	0	2
16	**Kevin Keegan**	2	0	0	2
17	**Kylian Mbappé**	0	2	0	2
18	**Paolo Rossi**	1	1	0	2
19	**Valentin Ivanov**	0	1	1	2
20	**Ademir**	0	1	0	1

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
21	Alan Dzagoev	0	0	1	1
22	Alan Shearer	0	0	1	1
23	Allan Simonsen	1	0	0	1
24	Andriy Shevchenko	1	0	0	1
25	Antoine Griezmann	0	0	1	1
26	Bobby Charlton	1	0	0	1
27	Cody Gakpo	0	0	1	1
28	Dani Olmo	0	0	1	1
29	David Villa	0	0	1	1
30	Davor Šuker	0	1	0	1
31	Denis Law	1	0	0	1
32	Dennis Bergkamp	0	0	1	1
33	Dezső Novák	0	0	1	1
34	Dieter Müller	0	0	1	1
35	Dragan Džajić	0	0	1	1
36	Fabio Cannavaro	1	0	0	1

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
37	Ferenc Bene	0	0	1	1
38	Fernando Torres	0	0	1	1
39	François Heutte	0	0	1	1
40	Garrincha	0	1	0	1
41	Gary Lineker	0	1	0	1
42	George Best	1	0	0	1
43	George Weah	1	0	0	1
44	Georges Mikautadze	0	0	1	1
45	Gianni Rivera	1	0	0	1
46	Grzegorz Lato	0	1	0	1
47	Guillermo Stábile	0	1	0	1
48	Henrik Larsen	0	0	1	1
49	Igor Belanov	1	0	0	1
50	Ivan Schranz	0	0	1	1
51	Jamal Musiala	0	0	1	1
52	James Rodríguez	0	1	0	1

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
53	**Jean-Pierre Papin**	1	0	0	1
54	**Jesús María Pereda**	0	0	1	1
55	**Josef Masopust**	1	0	0	1
56	**Just Fontaine**	0	1	0	1
57	**Kaká**	1	0	0	1
58	**Karim Benzema**	1	0	0	1
59	**Karl-Heinz Riedle**	0	0	1	1
60	**Klaus Allofs**	0	0	1	1
61	**Leonel Sánchez**	0	1	0	1
62	**Leônidas**	0	1	0	1
63	**Lev Yashin**	1	0	0	1
64	**Lothar Matthäus**	1	0	0	1
65	**Luís Figo**	1	0	0	1
66	**Luis Suárez**	1	0	0	1
67	**Luka Modrić**	1	0	0	1
68	**Mario Balotelli**	0	0	1	1

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
69	Mario Gómez	0	0	1	1
70	Mario Kempes	0	1	0	1
71	Mario Mandžukić	0	0	1	1
72	Matthias Sammer	1	0	0	1
73	Michael Owen	1	0	0	1
74	Milan Baroš	0	0	1	1
75	Milan Galić	0	0	1	1
76	Miroslav Klose	0	1	0	1
77	Oldřich Nejedlý	0	1	0	1
78	Oleg Blokhin	1	0	0	1
79	Oleg Salenko	0	1	0	1
80	Omar Sívori	1	0	0	1
81	Ousmane Dembélé	1	0	0	1
82	Patrick Kluivert	0	0	1	1
83	Pavel Nedvěd	1	0	0	1
84	Raymond Kopa	1	0	0	1

Rank	Player	Ballon d'Or	FIFA World Cup Golden Boot	UEFA EURO Golden Boot	Total
85	Rivaldo	1	0	0	1
86	Roberto Baggio	1	0	0	1
87	Rodri	1	0	0	1
88	Ronaldinho	1	0	0	1
89	Ruud Gullit	1	0	0	1
90	Salvatore Schillaci	0	1	0	1
91	Sándor Kocsis	0	1	0	1
92	Savo Milošević	0	0	1	1
93	Stanley Matthews	1	0	0	1
94	Thomas Müller	0	1	0	1
95	Tomas Brolin	0	0	1	1
96	Vavá	0	1	0	1
97	Viktor Ponedelnik	0	0	1	1
98	Zinedine Zidane	1	0	0	1

📚 References & review

Status: verified Last reviewed:29 October 2026

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- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 1 of 6) (https://www.wionews.com/sports/football-french-forward-ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-d-or-spain-s-lamine-yamal-settles-for-kopa-trophy-aitana-bonmati-1758568787767/amp)

- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 2 of 6) (https://www.si.com/soccer/ousmane-dembele-wins-2025-ballon-dor)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 3 of 6) (https://thesefootballtimes.co/2017/08/23/lev-yashin-the-only-goalkeeper-to-win-the-ballon-dor/)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 4 of 6) (https://global.espn.com/football/story/_/id/38742563/why-goalkeeper-never-win-ballon-dor-again)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 5 of 6) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1995_Ballon_d%27Or)
- **Third independent cross-check of the Winners table and two superlative (source 6 of 6) (https://www.90min.com/posts/ballon-d-or-1995-george-weah-delivers-football-s-greatest-individual-prize-to-africa)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 1 of 10) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/FIFA_Ballon_d%27Or)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 2 of 10) (https://bleacherreport.com/articles/1881792-how-is-the-ballon-dor-winner-selected)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 3 of 10) (https://www.si.com/soccer/2015/01/12/jurgen-klinsmann-ballon-dor-ballot-messi-ronaldo-neuer-robben)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 4 of 10) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-voting.htm)
- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 5 of 10) (https://www.footyheadlines.com/2016/09/say-goodbye-to-fifa-ballon-dor.html)
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- It also didn't mention a real 2022 reform that shrank the journalist (source 10 of 10) (https://foot-africa.com/en/news/ballon-dor-namibia-excluded-from-the-2025-jury-875946/)
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- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 2 of 5) (https://reuters.screenocean.com/record/334880)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 3 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-2007.htm)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 4 of 5) (https://www.eurosport.co.uk/football/ballon-d-or/2022/black-history-month-how-george-weah-s-historic-1995-ballon-d-or-win-put-black-and-african-players-on_sto9192984/story.shtml)
- "Memorable moments" external-sourcing audit, and a real bug fix (source 5 of 5) (https://www.topendsports.com/sport/soccer/awards/ballondor-timeline.htm)
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- **Kopa Trophy (best young player) - Lamine Yamal, his third consecutive (source 1 of 3) (https://sports.yahoo.com/articles/lamine-yamal-wins-2026-ballon-212900002.html)
- **Kopa Trophy (best young player) - Lamine Yamal, his third consecutive (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-kopa-trophy-winners-202610)
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- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 1 of 3) (https://www.si.com/soccer/harry-kane-history-books-2026-gerd-muller-trophy)

- **Gerd Müller Trophy (top scorer) - Harry Kane, his second trophy (source 2 of 3) (https://khelnow.com/football/ballon-dor-gerd-muller-trophy-winners-202610)
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- 2024 UEFA EURO Player of the Tournament - already independently (https://businessday.ng/sports/article/euro-2024-rodri-wins-best-player-of-the-tournament)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 1 of 4) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Paolo_Rossi)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 2 of 4) (https://scroll.in/field/980819/scroll_in)
- Paolo Rossi's 1982 World Cup/Golden Ball/Golden Boot/Ballon d'Or sweep (source 3 of 4) (https://www.sportsmax.tv/studentwriters/itemlist/tag/Paolo%20Rossi)
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- Also checked the closest apparent rival claim, Ronaldo's 2002 World (source 2 of 2) (https://www.11v11.com/ronaldo/)
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- FIFA tournament history and champions (source 2 of 2) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/articles/world-cup-champions-1982-2026-italy-argentina-germany-brazil-france-spain)
- FIFA 2026 awards (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/award-winners)
- FIFA historical top scorers (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/fontaine-mbappe-ronaldo-and-more-every-world-cup-top-scorer)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 1 of 16) (https://blog.betway.com/football/world-cup/football-world-cup-winning-captains/)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 2 of 16) (https://www.fifaworldcupnews.com/fifa-world-cup-winning-captains-country/)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 3 of 16) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/wcwinners.html)
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- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 5 of 16) (https://sports.yahoo.com/videos/la-fuente-hands-rodri-spains-011309531.html)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 6 of 16) (https://www.uefa.com/european-qualifiers/news/02a6-20d159556fdf-60d8385f463f-1000--spain-at-the-world-cup-2026-squad-fixtures-group-and-history/)
- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 7 of 16) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-squad-announcement-luis-de-la-fuente)
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- Winning captains (added 2026-09-01, intensive run): a new "Winning (source 11 of 16) (https://www.laureus.com/world-sports-academy/members/cafu)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 1 of 8) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/rodri-earns-adidas-golden-ball)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 2 of 8) (https://www.espn.com/soccer/story/_/id/49404995/2026-world-cup-golden-ball-spain-unai-simon-pau-cubarsi)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 3 of 8) (https://www.beinsports.com/en-us/soccer/fifa-world-cup-2026/articles/why-did-the-world-cup-golden-ball-end-up-in-rodri-s-hands-2026-07-22)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 4 of 8) (https://www.olympics.com/en/news/fifa-world-cup-2026-messi-mbappe-bellingham-rodri-golden-ball-football)
- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 5 of 8) (https://www.foxsports.com/stories/soccer/2026-fifa-mens-world-cup-every-world-cup-golden-ball-winner-since-1982)
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- Golden Ball (best player) winners (added 2026-08-30, intensive run): a new (source 8 of 8) (https://www.topendsports.com/events/worldcupsoccer/golden-ball.htm)
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- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (source 2 of 8) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/fifa-gb86.html)
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (source 3 of 8) (https://www.rsssf.org/miscellaneous/fifa-gb90.html)
- Silver Ball and Bronze Ball (Golden Ball runners-up) winners (added (source 4 of 8) (https://www.fifa.com/en/news/articles/salvatore-schillaci-tribute-italy)
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- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (source 2 of 8) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/pau-cubarsi-fifa-young-player-award)
- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (source 3 of 8) (https://www.foxsports.com/stories/soccer/world-cup-pau-cubarsi-spain-young-player-award)
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- Young Player Award (best player aged 21 or under) winners (added (source 8 of 8) (https://www.topendsports.com/events/worldcupsoccer/best-young-player.htm)
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- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (source 1 of 17) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1930_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (source 2 of 17) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1966_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (source 3 of 17) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2022_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates audit (2026-08-02): the calendar date of each edition's (source 4 of 17) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2026_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (source 1 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1934_FIFA_World_Cup_final)

- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (source 2 of 5) (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/1994_FIFA_World_Cup_final)
- Final match dates second independent cross-check (2026-08-09, intensive (source 3 of 5) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/final)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (source 1 of 3) (https://www.espn.com/soccer/)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (source 2 of 3) (https://plus.fifa.com/)
- Third/fourth-place audit (2026-08-04): the winner and loser of every (source 3 of 3) (https://www.athlet.org/)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (source 1 of 6) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/spain-argentina-final-report-highlights)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (source 2 of 6) (https://www.espn.com/soccer/match/_/gameId/760517/argentina-spain)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (source 3 of 6) (https://www.cbsnews.com/news/2026-fifa-world-cup-final-spain-argentina-sunday/)
- **One discrepancy found and fixed:** the Final column read "Spain 1-0 (source 4 of 6) (https://www.fifa.com/en/tournaments/mens/worldcup/canadamexicousa2026/articles/france-england-report-highlights-bronze-final)
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Primary sources are preferred. Historical formats and team names are recorded as used at the time; see each edition's notes for context.